

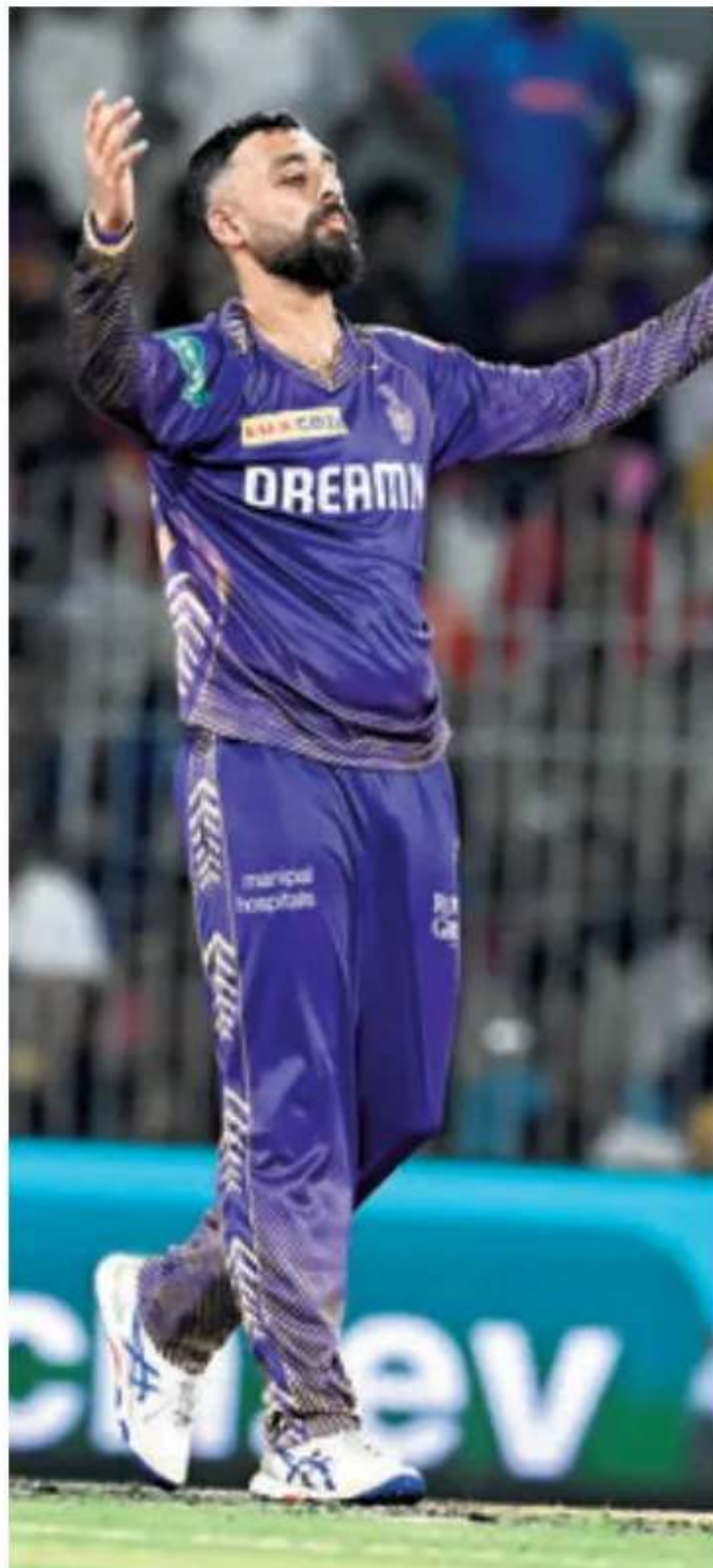


dividends as he added an IPL title to his rich haul of Ranji Trophy wins. Nayar, who has been with the franchise since 2018 and worked extensively with Venkatesh, Rinku, and 18-year-old Angkrish Raghuvanshi, was hailed as KKR's unsung hero.

"All I can think right now is of the person who built this Indian core: Abhishek Nayar," Chakravarthy said after winning the final in Chennai.

Raghuvanshi, who shone briefly but brightly and turned heads with a brisk fifty in his debut innings in the league, also termed Nayar his 'guru' and credited the former India international for helping him with his game, training, and diet.

"The youngsters are fearless in their approach and their attitude is headstrong. A lot of them are versatile in terms of their approach and proactive. When you give them freedom and back them during



On the ball: KKR was the only side to have six bowlers in the squad who picked 10 or more wickets in the season, three of whom were Harshit Rana (above, right), Vaibhav Arora and Chakravarthy. K. R. DEEPAK

tough times, that's when they deliver the best. When these guys step up at the right time, they see to it that they win matches," Iyer had said, summing up the contributions made by his Indian talent group.

SRH too had its fair share of domestic players who made their presence felt. **Nitish, the Emerging Player of the Season, had a stabilising influence in the middle-order,** scoring 303 runs at a strike rate of over 140. He demonstrated the potential to be groomed as a seam-bowling all-rounder — a commodity in short supply in the Indian market.

The opening duo of Abhishek and